Response™

Real Estate Investor Series

Business Set Up And Marketing

Workbook

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What You Will Learn

Upon completion of this lesson you will be able to:

- Set up and register your business
- Set up necessary contact options for your business
- Determine your marketing objectives
- Evaluate and select appropriate marketing techniques for your target market(s)
- Get referrals
- Create a marketing plan and budget
- Recognize common marketing mistakes to avoid

Lesson Glossary

Business types Business organization characterized by unique features such as ease of set-up, tax regulations, and degree of asset protection offered. Some common business types include various types of corporations, partnerships, limited liability companies, charities, and trusts.

Demographics Key characteristics of an area or of a group of people that are used to identify marketing efforts and techniques.

Marketing plan Outline of the specific actions you intend to carry out to interest potential sellers/buyers in your services and persuade them to sell/buy with you.

Marketing budget The amount allocated for expenditure on marketing activities in a specified period.

Activity 1, Initial Thoughts for Your Business Marketing Plan

You can record your initial thoughts, goals, and plans for marketing your business on this page. This is an optional activity.

1. What are your goals? What kinds of deals do you want to go after?

_____

_____

_____

_____

2. Who are you going to sell to, and what do you know about them?

_____

_____

_____

3. What do you need to do to achieve your goals? What are the steps? What are the obstacles?

_____

_____

_____

_____

4. How long will it take to complete each step?

_____

_____

_____

_____

5. Other thoughts for completing the actions and steps listed above

_____

_____

_____

_____

Activity 2, Set-up Your Business

Select a Name

STEP 1: Select a name for your business. You may want to refer back to the guidelines offered in the online *Business Set-up and Marketing Lesson*. Use the Business Name Worksheet below to brainstorm possible business names.

Example

Industry Names	Famous Local Place Names	Personal/ Initial Names
Geared Investments	Rocky Mountain Properties	Smith Investments
Secure Property Solutions	Delaware Investment Solutions	G & L Properties
Sound Investments	Grove City Properties	HAL Funding
Solid Funding Solutions	Pioneer Property Solutions	Peoples Properties

Business Name Worksheet

Industry Names	Famous Local Place Names	Personal/ Initial Names

STEP 2: Talk with an attorney or accountant about your business goals and personal finances. Ask this person to help you identify the best business type for your real estate business. Get assistance, if needed, to register it with the state and to create all required paperwork.

STEP 3: Conduct research and determine the best communication services for your real estate business. Solidify your contact information. Use the form below to identify your business contact information.

Example

Business Contact Information Form	
Business Name: Smart Property Solutions, LLC	
Registration State: NV	**Established Date:** 4/3
EIN #: 1234567	**Partners:** Mike Smith & Jim Dean
Fax: xxx-xxx-xxxx	**Address:** 1234 Dead End St., Peace, NV
Phone Number: xxx-xxx-xxxx	**Email Address:** xxx@email.com
Website Address: www.mine.com	**Ownership:** 33%

Business Contact Information Form

Business Contact Information Form	
Business Name:	
Registration State:	**Established Date:**
Employer Identification Number (EIN):	**Partners:**
Fax:	**Address:**
***Phone Number:**	****Email Address:**
Website Address:	**Ownership:**

*Go to www.kall8.com or www.ureach.com to get a toll-free number or look into other business telephone services.

**Get an email alias at www.google.com.

Activity 2, Marketing Techniques

You can use this space to make notes on the different marketing techniques as explained in the *Business Set-up and Marketing Lesson*; possible ways to use them; their strengths, weaknesses, and costs; and possible sources that you want to follow-up with. Having this information readily at hand will make it easier for you to remember and use when the time comes.

Classified ads

_____

_____

_____

_____

Signs

_____

_____

_____

_____

Direct Mail (postcards, fliers, and letters)

_____

_____

_____

_____

Business cards and brochures

_____

_____

_____

_____

Referrals

_____

_____

_____

_____

Activity 3, Marketing Plans

Identify Target Area Features

STEP 1: Use the Demographics Worksheet in the *What To Look For? Workbook* to identify your target areas and audiences.

STEP 2: Fill in the respective fields in the Target Areas Worksheet below.

Example

Target Audience	Area	Property Types	Market Condition	Investment Strategy
Young families	Oak City	SFR	Slowing/ Foreclosures	Fast Cash
Students/Renters	Mid-town	Condo/Town home	School back in session	Buy & Hold or Cash Flow
Military/ Investors	Layton	Manufactured Homes/ SFR	Closing military base	Buy & Hold or Cash Flow
Mature couples / down Sizing	Payson	Town home/ SFR	Desirable area	Fast Cash or Cash Flow

Target Area Features Worksheet

Target Audience	Area	Property Types	Market Condition	Investment Strategy

NOTE: Use this worksheet until you become familiar with the steps necessary to evaluate your possible target audiences and areas.

Marketing Questionnaire

STEP 3: Once you have identified your target areas, audiences, market conditions, and investment strategies you are ready to start answering the questions that will guide the creation of your marketing plan. Fill in the Marketing Questionnaire for each target area and audience below.

Example

Target Area and Audience: Oak City, young families	**Investment Strategy:** Fast Cash	**Marketing Technique(s):** Postcards & Classifieds – free online & freebie
Marketing Questionnaire		**Responses**
1. Who is the target of my marketing? (buyers, sellers, or investors)		Buyers and sellers
2. How much can I afford to spend to start marketing? Where will my marketing money come from? How much of my budget will I allot to each target group per month?		$300 from business line of credit $150 for this target area. Buyers = 33%, Sellers = 66%
3. What techniques will work best with each group? What resources should I use to produce the various marketing products? How many times in a month do I need to pay for the marketing? What are the costs for each marketing technique per month?		Buyers –classified ads Sellers - postcards, letters www.postcardwebsite.com – design, print and mail postcards, 1x/month, $107.48 (to print & ship 150 postcards) www.americanclassifieds.com - freebie classifieds, 1x/4 weeks, $24/4 weeks www.seekitlocal.com & www.craigslist.com – free online classifieds free, update 2x/month
Do my total estimated marketing costs per month fit with what I have to spend?		$107.48 + $24 = $131.48
4. How many leads do I expect per week from my marketing efforts? How many deals do I expect per month from my marketing efforts?		Buyers = 15 Sellers = 25 Buyers = 1 Sellers = 2
5. Which keywords am I going to use in my advertising?		Seller = We Buy Houses, Quick Closing Buyer = Buy Below Market Value, Instant Equity

NOTE: Make additional copies of the form on the next page as needed.

Marketing Questionnaire

Target area and audience:	Investment Strategy:	Marketing Technique(s):

Marketing Questionnaire	Responses
1. Who is the target of your marketing? (buyers, sellers, or investors)	
2. How much can I afford to spend to start marketing? Where will my marketing money come from? How much of my budget will I allot to each target group per month?	
3. What techniques will work best with each group? What resources should I use to produce the various marketing products? How many times in a month do I need to pay for the marketing? What are the costs for each marketing technique per month?	
Do my total estimated marketing costs per month fit with what I have to spend?	
4. How many leads do I expect per week from my marketing efforts? How many deals do I expect per month from my marketing efforts?	
5. Which keywords are you going to use in your advertising?	

The Basic Plan

STEP 4: The basic plan contains general information for each target area, and is based on the information you have gathered on the Demographics Worksheet and the Target Area Features Worksheet. In the first row put the specific target area in which you are planning to market. In the second row put the specific groups you are targeting. These could be buyers and renters, sellers, other investors, or networking contacts.

Example

	Target #1: Oak City			Target #2: Mid-town		
	Buyers/ Renters	Sellers	Investors	Buyers/ Renters	Sellers	Networking Contacts
Technique	Ads, Sign	Post-cards	Letters	Signs	Letters	Phone calls
Producer	Freebie.com	Print Shop	Kinkos	Acme Sign Co.	Kinkos	Self
Time to produce	3 days	1 week	2 days	1 day	5 days	4 hours
Duration or Frequency	4 weeks	1x/mo.	1x/ 3 mos.	4 weeks	1x/2 mos.	1x/2 mos.
Responses Planned/ Actual	30	20	10/6	20/	50/26	15/14
ansactions nned/ tual	2/1	1/	1/	1/	2/1	1/
Budget Planned/ Actual	$40/$59	$132/ $120	$10/$10	$100/$95	$200/$240	$0
Money Source	BLOC	BLOC	Savings	Credit Card	Savings	N/A

The Basic Plan

	Target #_____:			Target #_____:		
Technique						
Producer						
Time to produce						
Duration or Frequency						
Responses Planned/ Actual						
Transactions Planned/ Actual						
Budget Planned/ Actual						
Money Source						

Marketing Schedule

STEP 5: Use the Marketing Schedule to keep track of the marketing activities you are planning and when you plan to do them. Create a schedule each month for each of your target areas.

Example

Marketing Schedule for *October*, 2008 **Target Area:** Oak City

Technique	Week 1	Week 2	Week 3	Week 4	Week 5	Results	Costs
#1. Postcards	*Complete design, Make 500 copies*	*Address and mail*				Responses: ~~IIII~~IIII Offers: III Trans actions:	$50, printing $47, postage CPL= $10.66
#2. Fliers			Distribute on 3rd and 4th Streets			Responses: ~~IIII~~I Offers: III Trans actions: I	$42, printing CPL= $7.00
#3. Signs	On Fri, put open house signs at 2335 3rd St.			Buy 5 new property signs		Responses: ~~IIII IIII~~ Offers: Trans actions:	$150, signs CPL= $15.00
Referrals/ Followup	Call Bob Smith 555-5555 (responded to sign on Jack St.)	Call Bill Sanders- Check on his foreclosure	Call Andy Johnson- See if he is ready to sell			Responses: III Offers: I Trans actions:	$20, lunch CPL= $6.66
		Call Billybob Jefferson, 555-4565, he might sell.	Check on new properties Pam Silva has listed			Responses: IIII Offers: II Trans actions:	CPL= $0
						Total Costs:	$289 Avg CPL: $9.03

Marketing Schedule

Marketing Schedule for _____ , _____ Target Area: _____

Technique	Week 1	Week 2	Week 3	Week 4	Week 5	Results	Costs
						Responses: Offers: Trans actions:	CPL= $_____
						Responses: Offers: Trans actions: I	CPL= $_____
						Responses: : Offers: Trans actions:	CPL= $_____
						Responses: Offers: Trans actions:	CPL= $_____
						Responses: Offers: Trans actions:	CPL= $_____
						Total Costs:	Avg CPL: $_____

Marketing Evaluation

STEP 6: We recommend that you evaluate your marketing efforts at the end of each month for the first several months. Once you get a good idea of what works and what doesn't, evaluating once a quarter should be sufficient. As part of your evaluation, ask the questions listed here of each of your target areas and audiences. If you decide you want to change something as a result of your evaluation, go back to your basic marketing plan and schedule and make the needed revisions.

1. What percentage of my profits should I use on marketing?
2. How frequently do I need to spend money on marketing in order to be most effective, and how much each time?
3. Do I have the best price for this marketing technique?
4. Is there a way to reduce the cost of this technique and still be effective?
5. Is there an alternative to this marketing approach that is cheaper but just as effective?

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